

Death of a star

Stars are born, live out their lives, and, ultimately, die. In dying, all their elements are thrown back into the clouds of gas and dust from which they formed, and the process begins again.

Moon of planet below



Getting bigger...

When a star such as our Sun gets old, it begins to expand. It becomes a red giant or supergiant. This is because as it uses up its fuel – hydrogen – its centre or core becomes smaller and hotter. That leads to its expansion.

The surface of a planet whose sky is filled with a red giant star

did you know?
We are made from elements such as oxygen, hydrogen, carbon, and iron. While hydrogen has been around since time began, other elements form inside stars and spread when they die.

Artist's impression of our Sun losing its outer layers at the end of its life

The Moon

